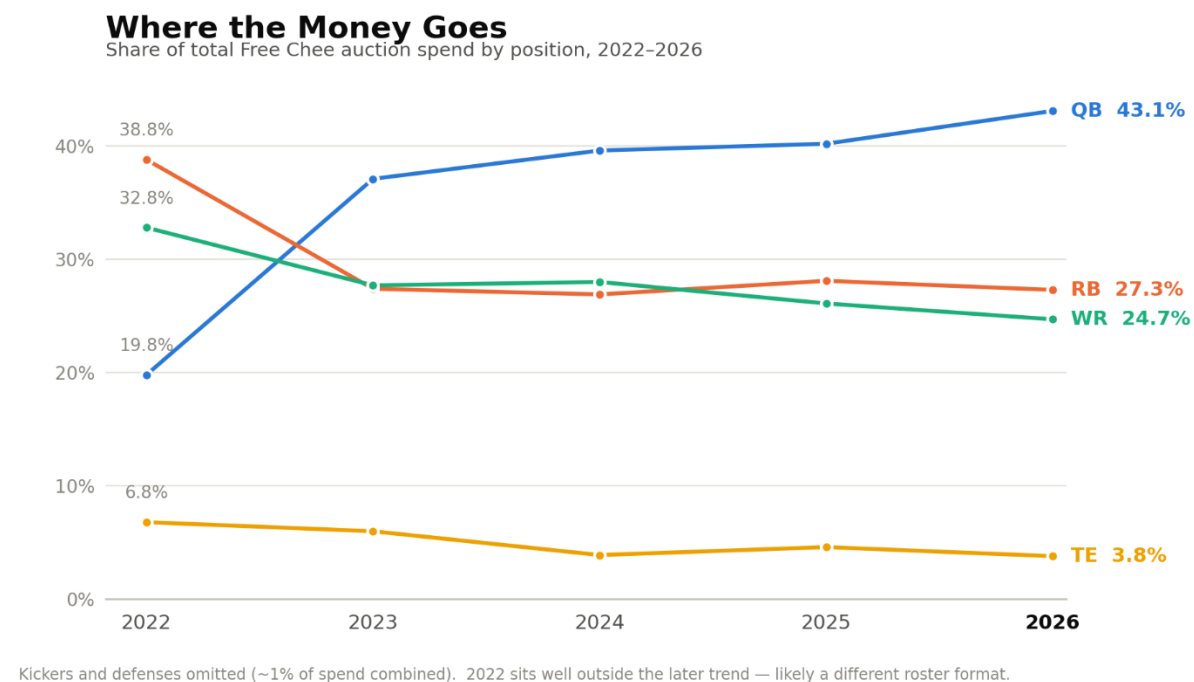


Free Chee Preseason 2026 Power Rankings

Welcome back, gentlemen. After a highly successful offseason in which Papi faced relegation, a new member was added in his place and Jalen Hurts grew a mustache, we are back.

This is the committee's initial rankings for 2026 and in an effort to be as transparent, unbiased and ethical as possible the committee made an executive decision to forego any model inputs for this round. These rankings are based entirely on intense discussion and debate in the committee room.

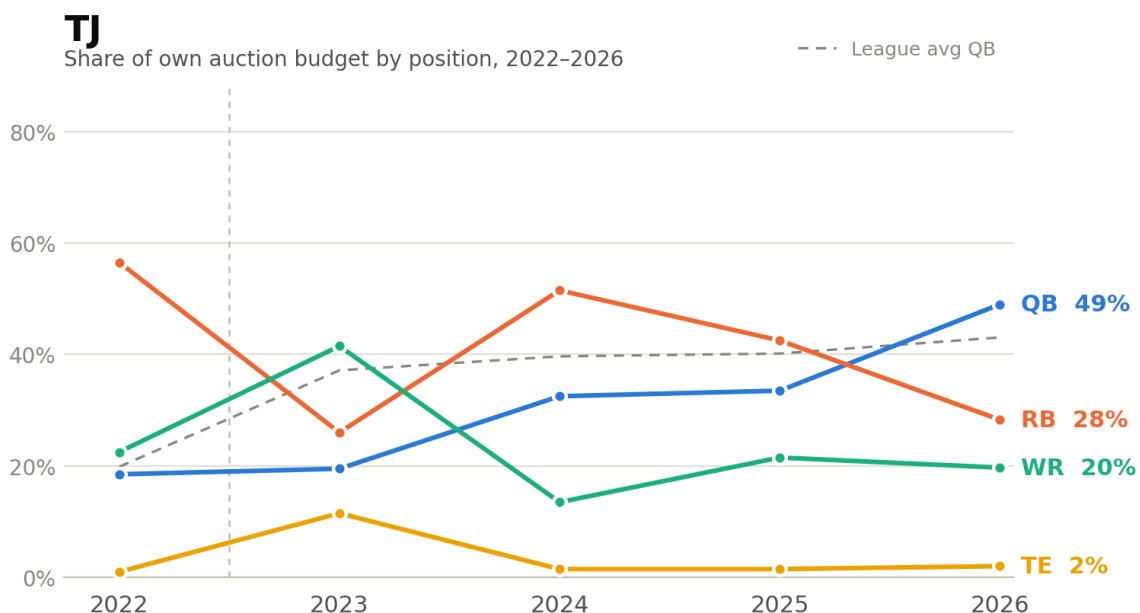
A record 43.1% of this year's dollars were spent on quarterbacks. 21 of the 25 most expensive players in the entire auction were quarterbacks. "John" Tyler Shough cost \$46. This is part of a league-wide trend of analytically minded owners allocating increased capital towards the ever-important quarterback position. As you can see in the table below, this is a continuation of a trend since the first year in 2022 where we as a league didn't fully understand the importance of the quarterback.



Now without further ado, we present the preseason rankings for 2026.

1. Boone (TJ)

After a disheartening end to 2025 in which Boone slid from a peak of #1 in the rankings in WK8 to 5-9 and out of the playoffs, he spent all offseason channeling that disappointment into optimizing his draft strategy. And the committee certainly believes it paid off. In the committee room, there was near-unanimous support for Boone as our preseason #1 team. He spent big on Jalen Hurts much to Connecticut's chagrin, but he got Baker Mayfield at a bargain price of \$35. This allowed him to spread his money around on a myriad of role players with solid upside. Derrick "King" Henry is back to kick Father Time's teeth in again as he goes for his 5th consecutive finish as a top-8 RB. Beyond that, the committee loved the Jaylen Waddle, D'Andre Swift, Christian Watson and Parker Washington pickups at cost. Boone appears to have a floor of a playoff team and if things break right he'll be the clear league favorite.



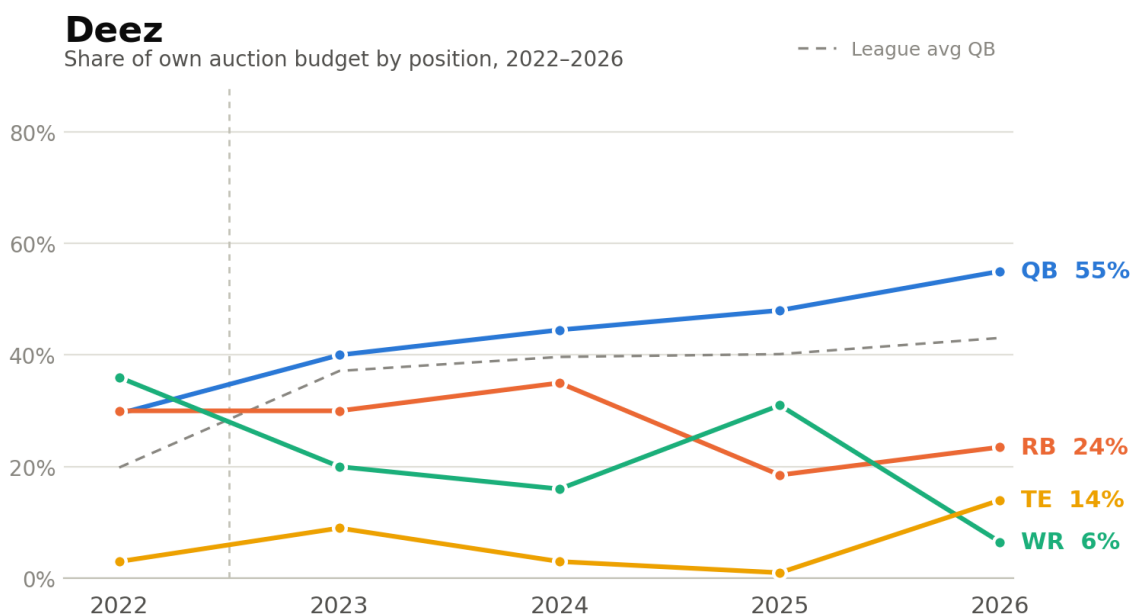
TJ spent a career high amount on QBs in this year's auction. In the past, he's been more of a bargain shopper for QBs but apparently saw value in spending heavier on a stalwart like Jalen Hurts this year.

Best Value: Tucker Kraft for \$4. Tuck was really coming into his own last year before his season ending injury. He was averaging 14.6 points per game when he went out for the season last year. We fully expect Kraft to be a focal point for Matt LaFleur and the Packers.

Biggest Reach: Kaimi for \$2

2. Pigs on the 7th Rank (Deez)

The committee really liked the way Pigs executed his strategy. He decided wide receiver was where he wanted to compromise. A year after getting burned on a couple of expensive purchases (Tyreek and Terry McLaurin), Pigs reallocated his capital to more premium positions, including spending a career high \$110 on the quarterback position. Lawrence and Mahomes are both high floor players who we would comfortably expect to finish in the top-15 among quarterbacks but they also have top-5 upside if things break right. Additionally, he locked down some solid if unspectacular backs in Josh Jacobs, David Montgomery and Jaylen Warren. His ceiling may hinge on just how dominant Brock “Bartholomew” Bowers can be as he is essentially the WR1 for Pigs.



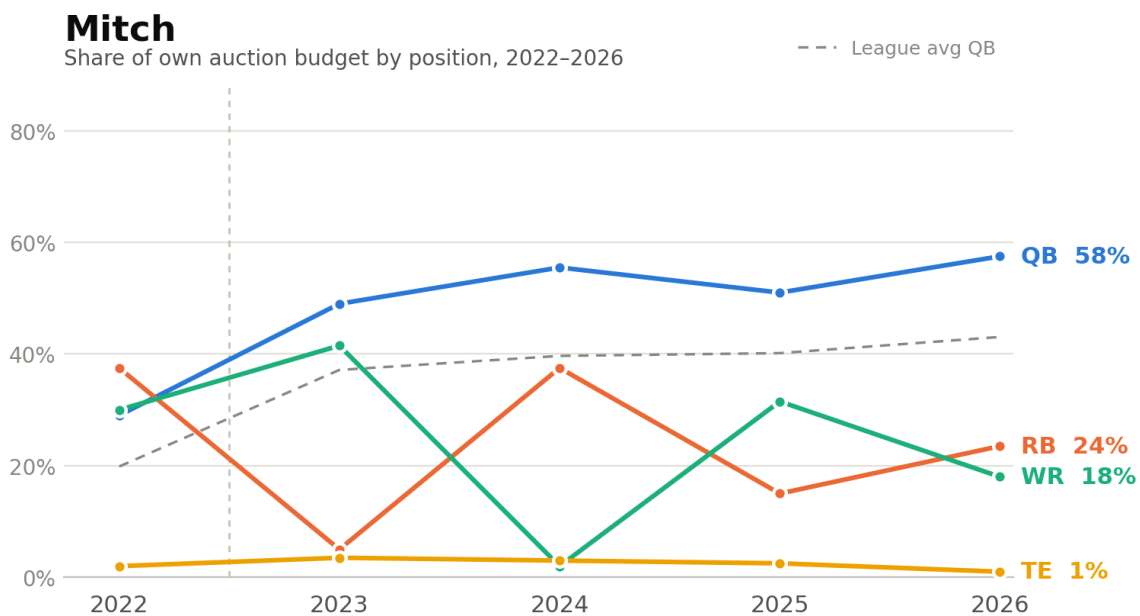
Best Value: Denzel Boston \$1. Denzel “Valentine” Boston has been the talk of Cleveland Browns training camp as reports suggest he is consistently mousing defenders despite the atrocious QB play.

Biggest Reach: No picks are egregious but the answer here is Josh Jacobs for \$21. The notorious criminal has shouldered quite the workload over the past couple years and between wear and tear and his legal issues, he’s not the sure thing he used to be.

3. Charles Dickens (Mitch)

Dickens has consistently stuck to his strategy and for the last two years it has rewarded him with 9-win seasons. He has been top-3 in QB spend in each draft since 2023. He went back to the well this year with two expensive QBs in Lamar Jackson (\$60) and Drake Maye (\$55) and then grabbed Chase and AJ Brown. This will be very much a stars and scrub

approach where if any of those four players bust, this team will be bad. However, if they hit, the committee likes the tertiary pieces around that core. Some might chirp the fact that he took four Patriots. Some might turn out to be right. But the consensus in the committee room was that the Patriots are due to be a top-2 (not two) offense in the league. He spent either \$2 or \$3 on six different players looking for cheap options with some upside. With Jayden Higgins now out for the season with a torn ACL and Tyrone Tracy potentially supplanted by Najee “Jeans” Harris, two of his \$3 players don’t look quite as good as they did on draft day.



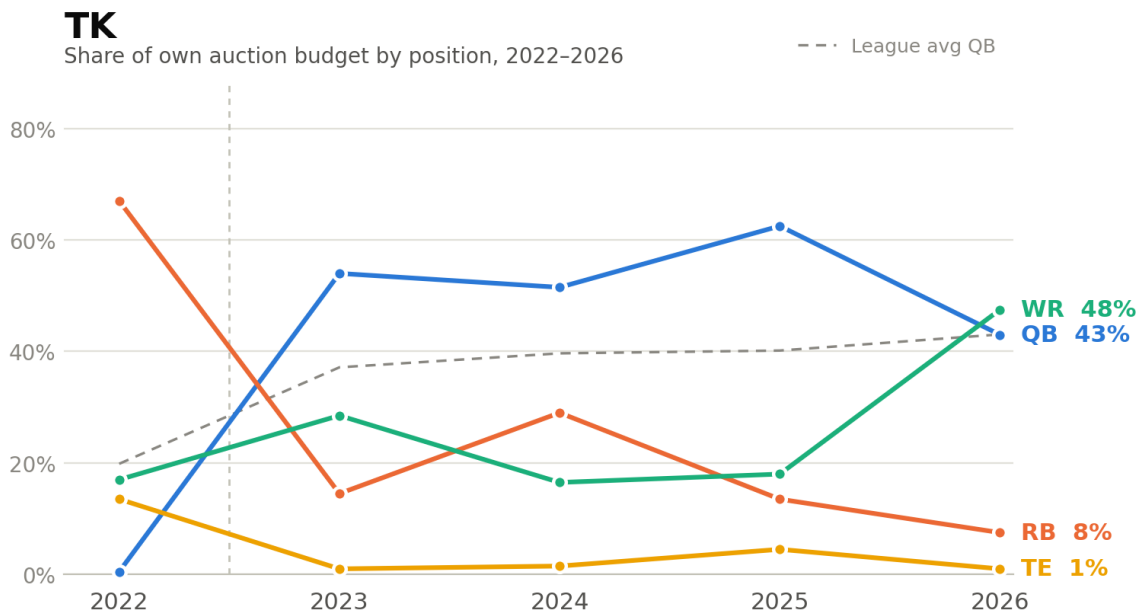
Best Value: Cyrus “The Great” Allen for \$1. Talk out of Chiefs camp is that this kid is electric. He’s decimating their rebuilt secondary and Mahomes has invited Allen to live with him to build chemistry heading into the season.

Biggest Reach: Easy to say now, but Jayden Higgins for \$3 stinks. He’s out for the year and the committee loved this guy.

4. Nick Wright Barely Legal (TK)

First, the committee could not stop talking about how Nick Wright has the best hair in the league. I am convinced that alone bumped him up a couple spots in these rankings. After that though, Nick dialed in the clear QB1 in Josh Allen and a potentially monster trio of receivers with Justin Jefferson, CeeDee Lamb and Davante Adams. The committee is willing to applaud Nick’s adaptability each year when it comes to his draft strategy. Jupiter even compared him to an amoeba in that regard. He spent by far a career high on wide

receivers this year. The risk is that his QB2 is Tua and you can never be too certain about his health. Still, this should be a playoff team and possibly more if some of his low cost RB flyers like Chuba “Hubba Bubba” Hubbard or Kyle “Schwarber” Monangai pan out.



Best Value: Davante Adams \$9. Touchdown machine on the best offense in the league. Cheap.

Biggest Reach: Aaron Jones Sr. \$2. How is he still lurking around?

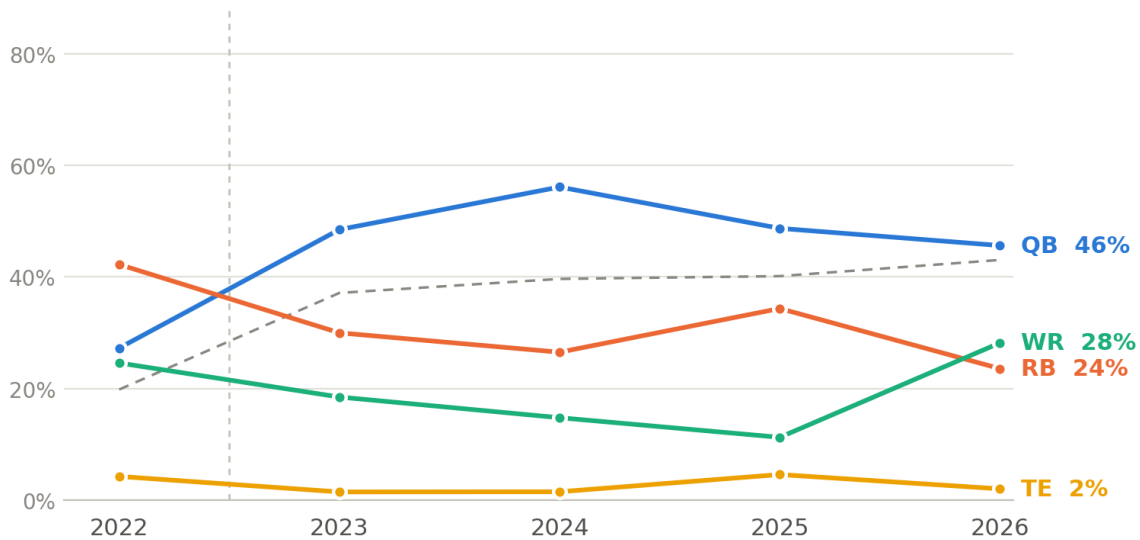
5. The Art of the Deal (Matt)

The committee really liked the top-4 teams. Then there was a bit of a dropoff, and we were collectively unsure who to rank next. So, we deferred to Mr. Consistency. Art of the D has not missed the playoffs in the first four years of the league and has been to three league title games. Even if we don't love a couple of his picks, the man has earned the benefit of the doubt. Achane and Pickens were no-brainers on this team as Art of the D consistently gets his guys. Having said that, he broke free of the Deshaun Watson curse this year. We're optimistic about Quentin Johnston and Kyle Pitts as high-upside plays. Beyond that, there was a lot of "IDK" type talk in the committee room until one of the fellas brought up Art's track record. Art continued to spend his dollars in a comparable manner to past years.

Matt

Share of own auction budget by position, 2022-2026

--- League avg QB



Best Value: Kyle Pitts Sr. \$5. Pitts finished as the TE2 in overall points last year and reports from our league insiders suggest that Stefanski and Tua love this guy. Stock is way up.

Biggest Reach: Michael Pittman Jr. \$4. Committee just hates the way this guy looks.

6. Ger

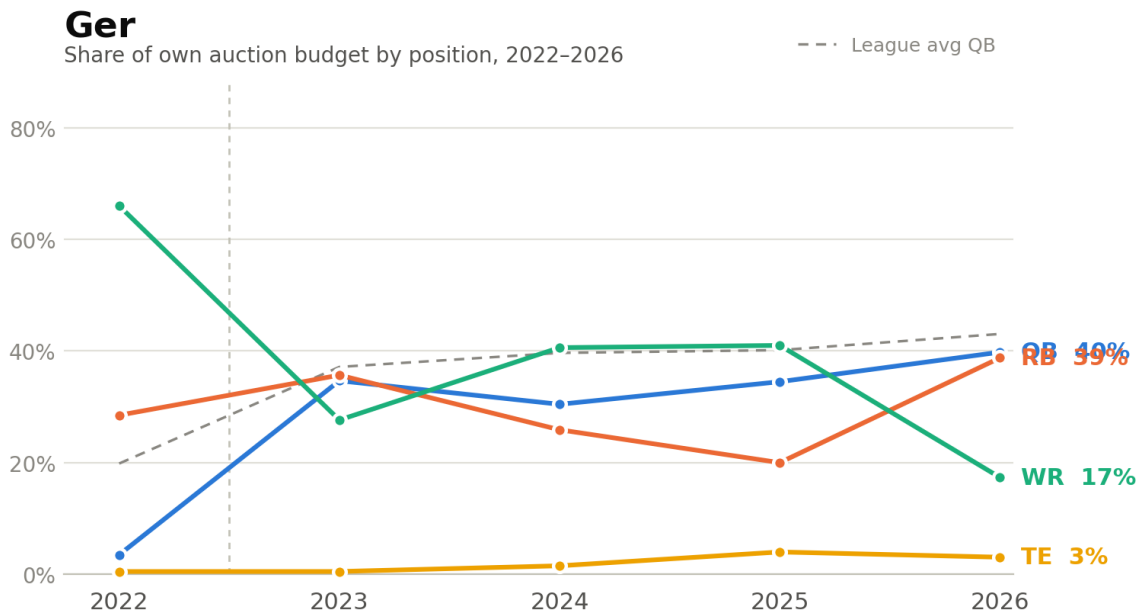
Ger came in with a measured approach and came out with a very nice team with one massive question mark. Let's start with the good. Caleb might not even be awesome at real football, and it will not matter because Ben Johnson is the Free Cheese of offensive coaches. James Cook will continue where he left off last year as a touchdown scoring machine for Buffalo. And Breece "Tammany" Hall is bound to break out one of these years, right?

We even like one or two of his role players. While Luther Burden III and Colston Loveland get all the hype in Chicago, Rome Odunze is stealthily amassing supporters and for \$8 that could prove to be an outstanding value. DJ Moore reunites with his OC from Carolina in Joe Brady which ought to help propel him to a bounce back season as Josh Allen's WR1. That's one of the benefits of living in Charlotte for Ger. He gets inside intel that nobody else in the league can get.

The biggest concern here is easily Geno "Auriemma" Smith. If the Jets are horrendous (imagine?), it is probable that Cade Klubnik might see some playing time late in the year and Ger would be in a pickle looking for a QB2.

Best Value: Jordan Mason \$3. Probably the starting running back for the Vikings and he's only \$3. The guy might suck cock at football and it won't matter because his only competition for touches is Aaron Jones.

Biggest Reach: C'mon lets be reasonable. He spent \$9 on Stefon Diggs. The guy fucks his male chef.



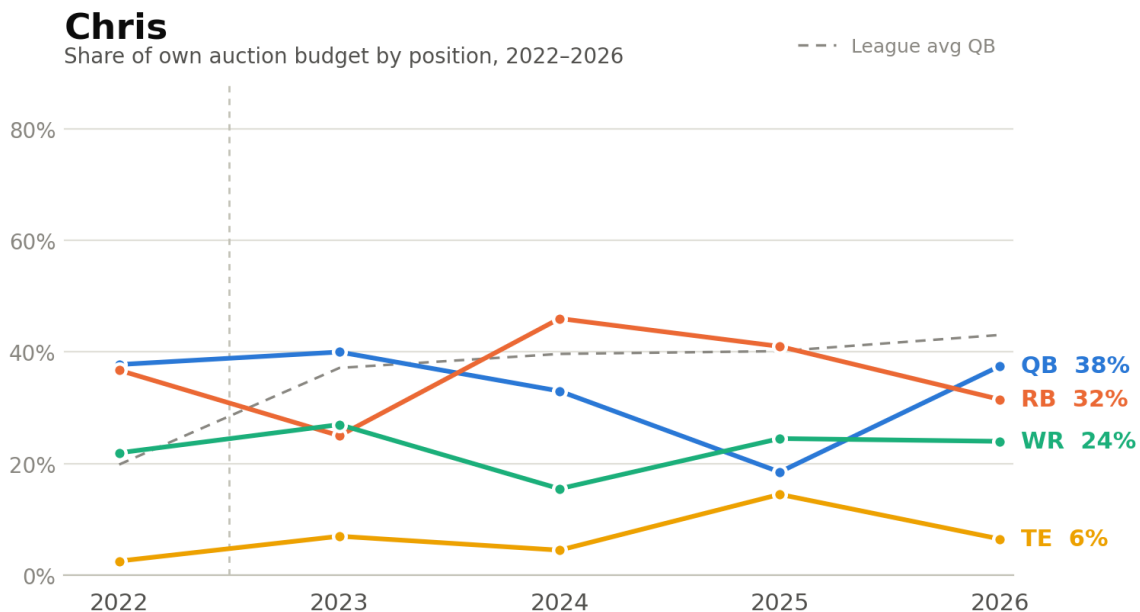
7. Ginny Sack (Chris)

After going mega cheap on QB last year (\$37 or the 2nd lowest total anyone has spent on QB since 2022), Chris upped his spending a little at the crucial position but still tied for 14th highest in the league. We love his skill position players. He's got depth and upside across running back and receiver with one of the most reliable tight ends in the league in Tyler Warren "Harding". However, his quarterbacks are Daniel Jones coming off an Achilles injury, Malik Willis and Shedeur Sanders. Now most people remember last year when Kendrick Perkins called Shedeur the most powerful black man in America since Barack Obama. That's not a joke. If you haven't seen the video, please watch it [here](#). The committee has discussed it at length with Hudson House. Hudson House was almost more emphatic about it than Kendrick Perkins was. But the committee believes Shedeur is a flat-out retard who can't play football. He'll soon be thrown on the trash heap of history alongside other Browns greats like DeShone Kizer and Cody Kessler.

Still, we mostly like Ginny's team.

Best Value: Jadarian Price \$14. While he may not be better than Jeremiyah Love as North Willow loves to claim, Price is nasty and he'll be the featured back for the reigning champs. \$14 is a steal.

Biggest Reach: Could it be anyone else? Shedeur \$11.



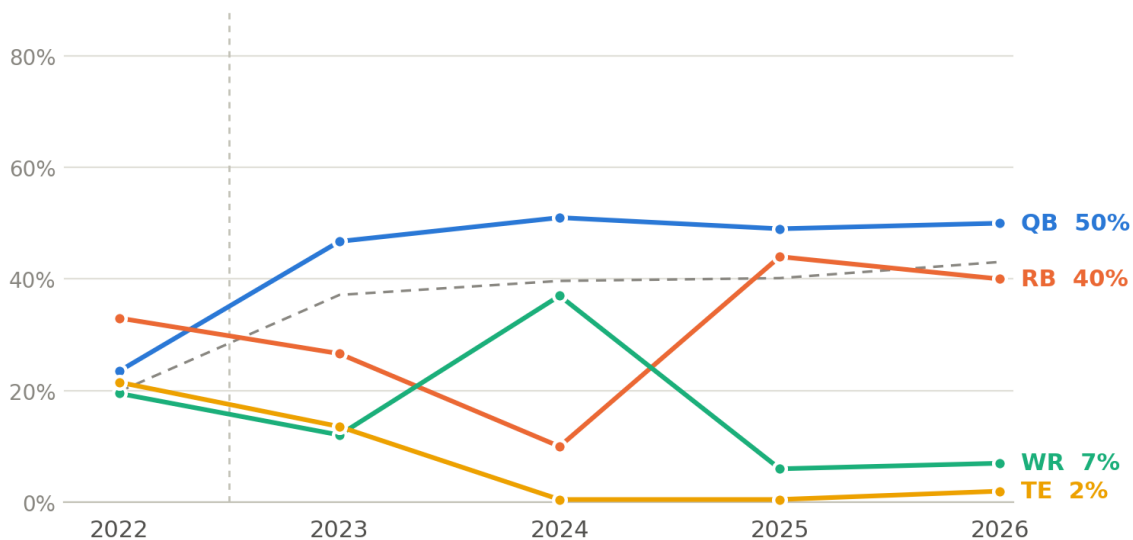
8. Shough and F#ck (Boyle)

This team has one sure thing on the entire roster, but that thing is Jahmyr “Joe” Gibbs so it’s pretty fucking nice. Gibbs should be the driving force behind a top-5 offense against one of the easiest schedules in the league. Quite frankly, the committee would be stunned if he averages less than 20 PPG. Once we get past that, the committee is high on Justin Herbert with Mike McDaniel calling that offense. If he can make Tua look good, the ceiling ought to be pretty high with Herbert. Next, De’Zhaun Stribling and KC Concepcion could prove to be absolute steals at their price point. Both have been the talk of training camp. However, they’re still unproven rookies so definitely some risk there. Michael Wilson is scrambled ass. Bill Merritt should be in prison. And Harold Fannin has Shedeur or Deshaun Watson at QB. But the biggest reason Shough and F#ck is not higher is Tyler Shough. The guy played a handful of games last year and was marginally better than the ugliest man in the league (Spencer Rattler). All of a sudden, North Willow decides to anoint him the next Daunte Culpepper? The committee doesn’t see it.

Boyle

Share of own auction budget by position, 2022-2026

-- League avg QB



After his first successful season in 2025, Shough decided to allocate his spend almost identically. Has he cracked the code or was 2025 a one-year fluke?

Best Value: Jalen Coker \$2. Who knew Boyle was a Cokehead after all?

Biggest Reach: Tyler Shough \$46. Guy is so old he was in high school during the Bush administration.

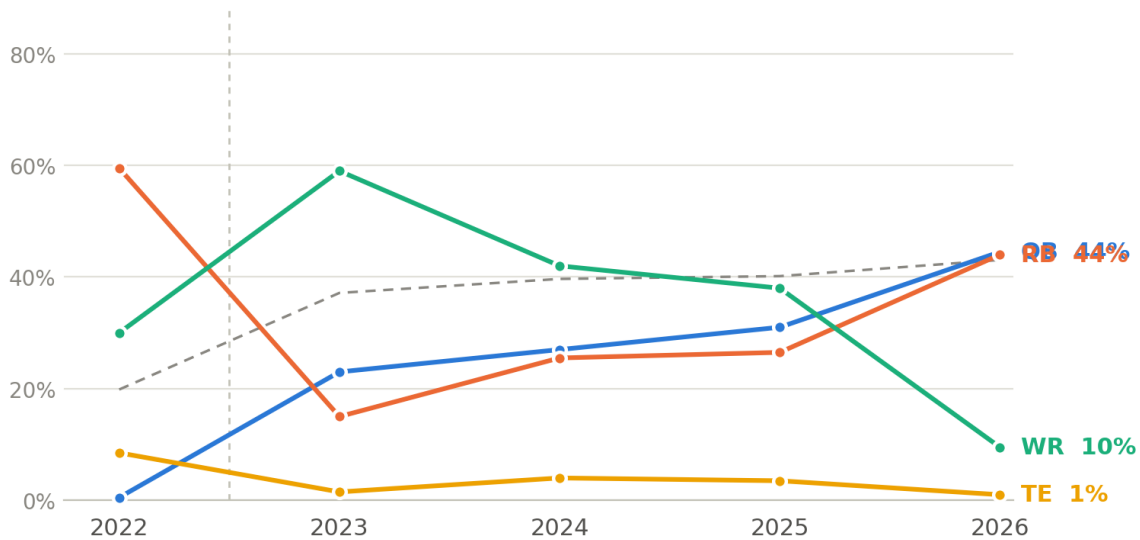
9. Phenom (Justin)

Phenom decided to implement a stars and scrubs strategy this year with him spending more than \$1 on only six guys. And one of those was Wan'Dale Robinson for \$2. Bijan is arguably the most reliable force in fantasy football these days. It doesn't matter if he has a dead deer at QB, he produces. Ashton Jeanty will look to build off a strong finish to his rookie year as the Raiders significantly improved the offensive line with the most expensive center contract ever handed out going to Tyler Linderbaum. However, the committee didn't love the Matthew Stafford and Sam Darnold duo. In 17 NFL seasons, Stafford has thrown for 30+ touchdowns only four times. And never in back-to-back years. As he's not a runner at all, his value mostly came from throwing a shitload of TDs and history suggests it will be hard to repeat that performance. Then Darnold loses his offensive coordinator, and the committee sees Seattle as a big regression candidate. We do love the Jonah "Derrick" Coleman pickup. The committee fully expects him to seize control of the Denver backfield when JK "Rowling" Dobbins inevitably gets hurt.

Justin

Share of own auction budget by position, 2022-2026

--- League avg QB



Phenom certainly loves his cheap tight ends. He has continued his trend of moving spend toward QB and RB in each season since 2023.

Best Value: Jonah Coleman \$1. He's goats.

Biggest Reach: Omar Cooper Jr. \$1. This guy is ass. Reports out of Jets camp suggest he's going to lose snaps to Isaiah Williams. Imagine being a first round pick and losing snaps to a create-a-player like that?

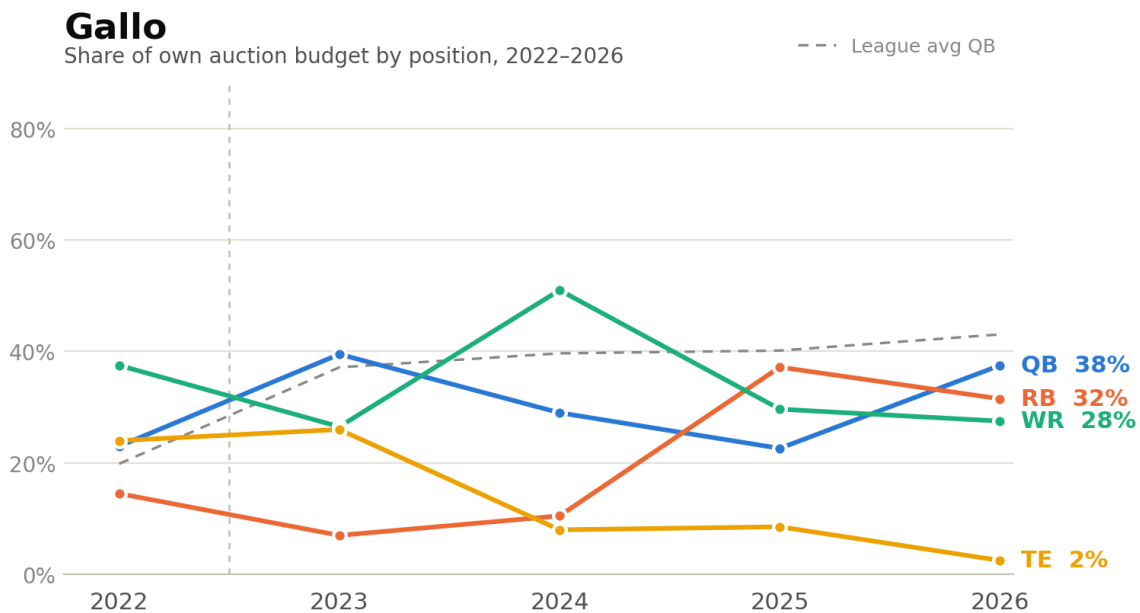
Editor's Note: Phenom must've seen the chirps coming because he wisely dropped Omar Cooper Jr. this morning in favor of Keenan Allen.

10. Free Paid (Gallo)

Some good and some bad here. Bo Nix for \$48 is clean. He's steady, just got a new WR1 and has been the QB7 overall in back-to-back seasons. Very good QB1. Jameson Williams is also a monster. He gets overlooked as Gibbs and Amon-Ra suck up all the oxygen around the Lions, but Williams has quietly been a top-20 receiver each of the last two seasons, and if Amon-Ra were to miss any time, he immediately becomes a slam dunk WR1.

Now for the bad. The Watson-Cousins QB2 platoon is the living embodiment of the cardboard disgrace pile. I'm not sure Cousins could outrun JB Pritzker at this point. And many are questioning if doubling down on Eagles with Saquon and DeVonta Smith is the most prudent team-building philosophy. DeVonta is due for a big uptick in volume with AJ Brown gone, but he still has the 17th best QB in football throwing him the pigskin. The bigger

concern is the new OC. Sean Mannion. This guy was a career third-string QB and has only been coaching for two seasons. He was the Packers QB coach last year. But he's supposed to return the Eagles to the promised land? Hard to see it.



Perhaps the most balanced spender in the league, Free Paid put between 20% and 40% of his budget into the three big positions for the 2nd consecutive year. After a 13-1 regular season, Free Paid looks to replicate that success with a similar draft strategy.

Best Value: Tee Higgins \$21. He's going to have a monster year.

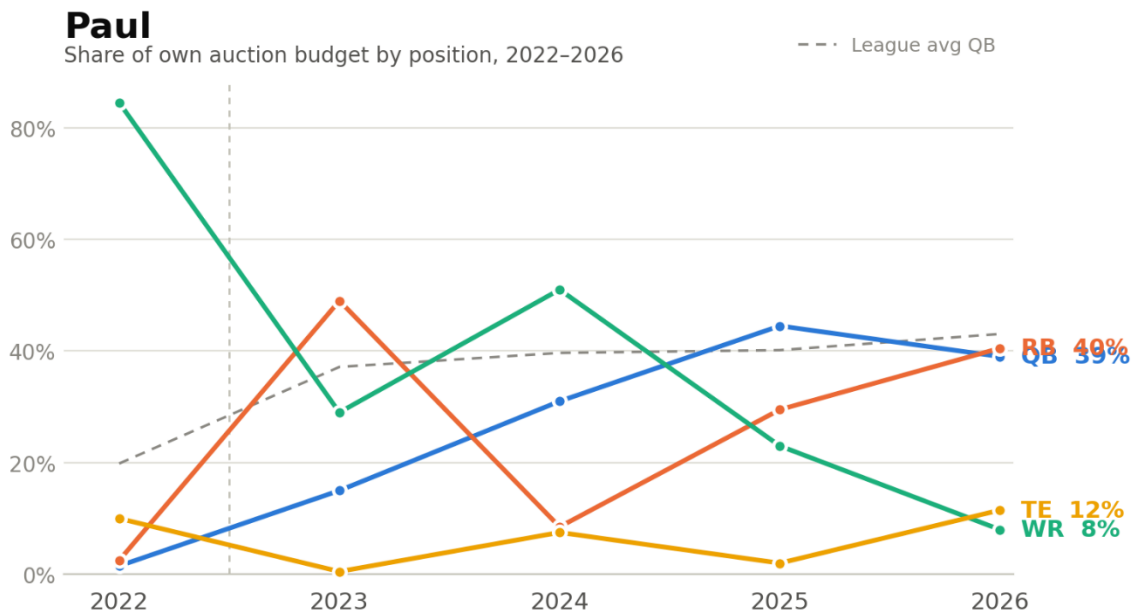
Biggest Reach: Kenny Gainwell \$6. Free Paid was once one of the biggest Bucky Irving guys on the planet and now he's spending \$6 to acquire Bucky's backup? Bucky will not take kindly to this disrespect.

11. Hello Darkness My Old Friend (Paul)

This team has the potential to be very good, but generally the committee is fading some of these guys. Let's start with the optimistic viewpoint. Armed with a state-of-the-art new training facility in Florida and access to top tier medical care that his competition can't get in Hoboken, Darkness keeps his team healthy and rolls into the playoffs for the first time. Jonathan Taylor and Kenneth Walker form an elite RB duo while Burrow and Aaron Rodgers sling the rock like it's 2021.

Now the alternative. Jordyn Tyson and Chris Godwin are his two best receivers, and both are coming off injuries. Neither can stay healthy and Darkness is stuck starting milkmen at

wide receiver. Rodgers looks washed up and begins doing weekly segments on Candace Owens' podcast. Despite strong performances from Taylor-Walker-Burrow, the rest of the lineup never really coalesces, and Darkness misses the playoffs again. Committee sees this scenario as more plausible than the first.



In 2022, Darkness spent \$168 combined on Ja'Marr Chase, Justin Jefferson and Mike Evans. That made it fairly challenging for him to fill out the rest of his roster. Since then, his spending habits have become much more in line with the rest of the league.

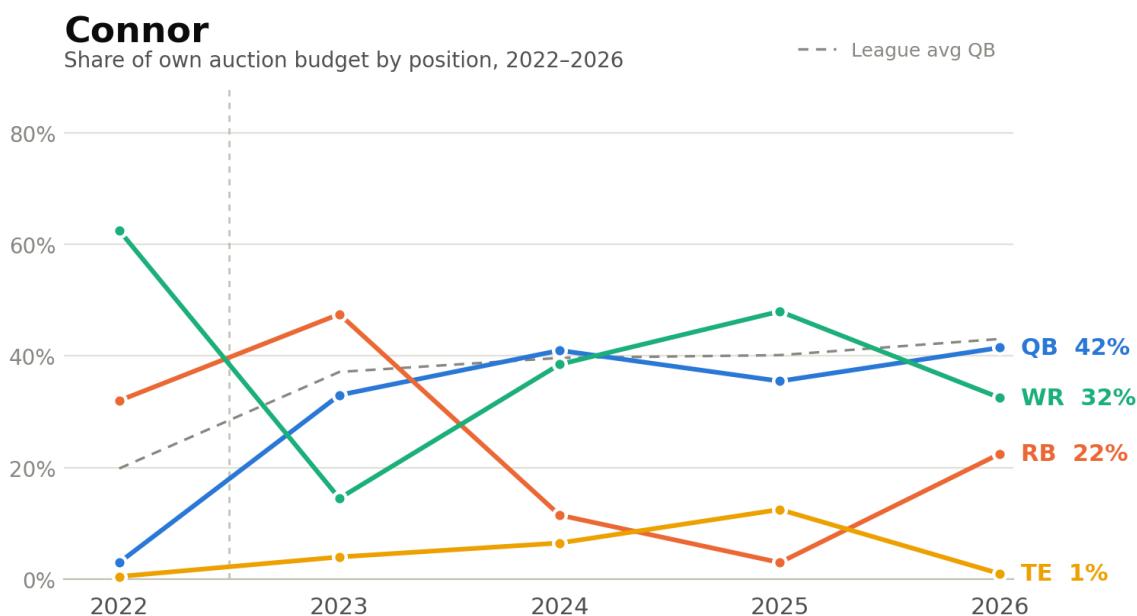
Best Value: Jalen Nailor \$1. Somebody has to catch passes in Vegas, right? Might as well bet on the guy they gave \$36M too. Also, people forget when [Nailor decimated Rutgers](#).

Biggest Reach: Jordyn Tyson \$5. The committee loves Tyson and thinks he's going to be nasty long-term, but he's already having hamstringing issues that are expected to rule him out for two months.

12. Healthy as a Fucking Rhino (Connor)

It's possible he might have a good team this year. After securing a new base of operations, we thought he might reassess his past draft strategies and try something new. He somehow still ended up with Cam Ward, but the rest of this team is clean. The committee has immense respect for the Goff-Amon-Ra duo. Always nice when you can stack the receiver and QB like that. Omarion Hampton has overall RB1 potential in the new Chargers offense. We expect him to look like a black Larry Csonka rumbling through AFC West defenses all

autumn. After that, we have some questions. Rhino claims that Yahoo (or Yahu? IDK) autodrafted Zay Flowers for him, but we're not so sure. Travis Etienne should prove to be a bargain as Alvin Kamara hits the PUP list. His complete lack of depth will likely prove problematic as he's currently looking at Braelon Allen or Troy "Benjamin" Franklin in his flex.



It's unfortunate we couldn't get accurate data on beers consumed each draft because the committee was very interested in running a regression analysis on beers consumed vs. spend for Rhino.

Best Value: Travis Etienne \$8. Etienne finished as the overall RB10 last year and looks to be the bellcow for Kellen Moore in New Orleans.

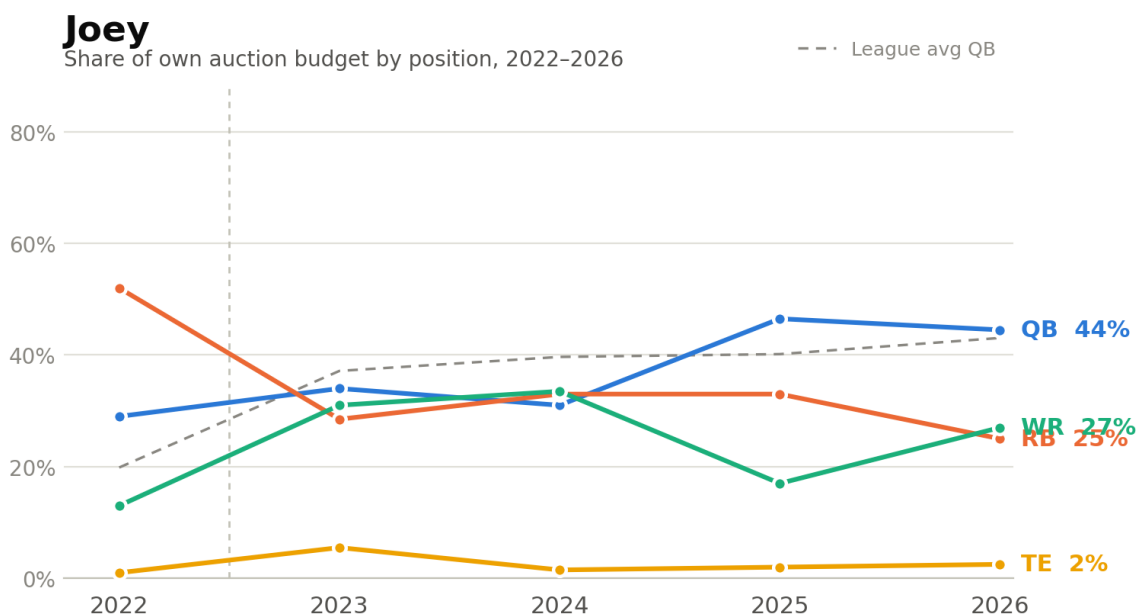
Biggest Reach: Rams defense for \$4. Questionable use of dollars as guys like Tucker Kraft, RJ Harvey, Josh Downs, and Jordan Addison all went for \$4 as well.

13. Stewed C (Joey)

Stewart went big on some fellas the committee just doesn't love and it hurts him in the initial rankings. First, it's important we take this opportunity to slander Jayden Daniels. After one of the more Mickey Mouse sophomore seasons we've seen, he decided it was important to get in a public spat over his college number than to focus on actually having a good season. Him, his retarded mom and the whole entourage. Funnily enough, it reminds the committee of CJ Stroud acting like he ran the league after one decent year. He was

[ranking himself top five](#), hosting terrible podcasts with Micah Parsons and just generally acting like a d-bag. It just so happens Stewed C drafted Stroud as well. He also spent big on Jeremiah Love at \$42. Love is ridiculously good at football, but as a rookie on what's projected to be one of the worst offenses in the league, there were better values at running back. For instance, Derrick Henry going for only \$33.

Having said all that, Stewed has some nice dart throws on the cheap. Keaton Mitchell is extremely fast and everyone knows how Mike McDaniels likes the speedsters. Dontayvion Wicks appears to be set up as the WR2 in Philly and MarShawn Lloyd looks prepared for a breakout year in Green Bay.



Stewed C seems to be very consistent in his approach. Anonymous sources tell the committee that he was “mega racked” at the draft. Highly impressive he remained so disciplined in that condition.

Best Value: Marcus Mariota \$2. Nasty QB handcuff to have.

Biggest Reach: Jeremiah Love \$42. He was the 6th most expensive running back right behind James Cook at \$43. Despite how good he is, the team situation makes that sort of production seem like a longshot for this year.

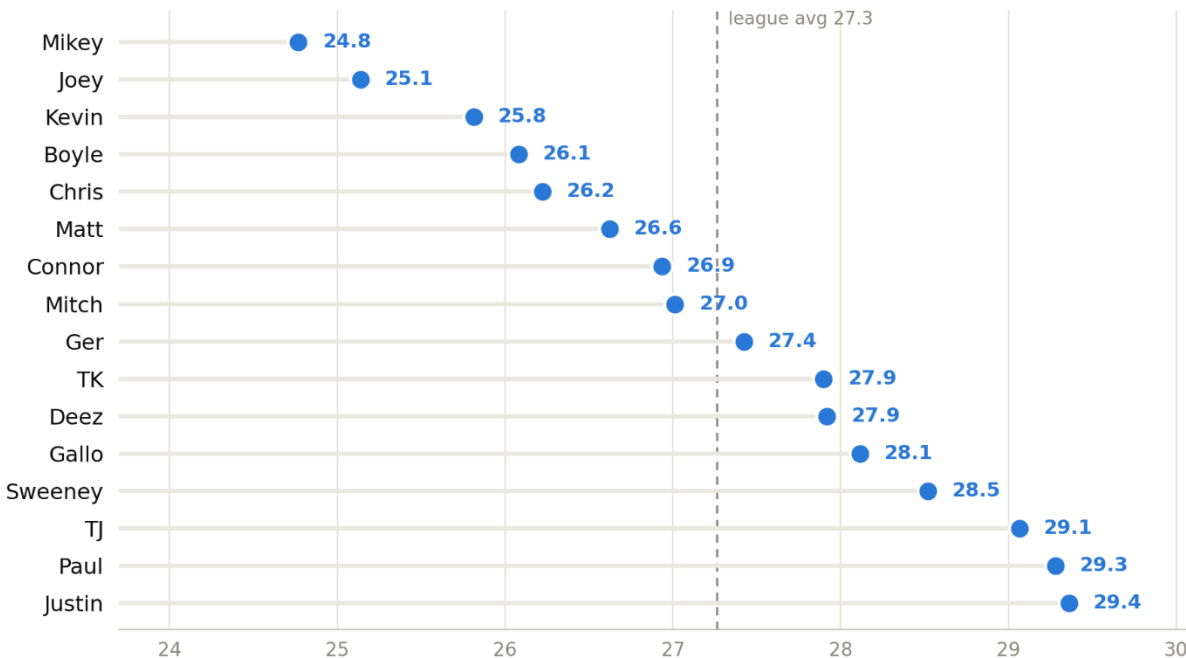
14. Pelosi's Powder (Mikey)

Pelosi really loves Brock Purdy. For the 3rd straight year, Purdy will helm Mikey's team. He also brings back Malik Nabers and Kyren as players he's rostered before. Pelosi is betting

heavily on younger guys with 4 rookies and the lowest spend-weighted average age in the league. Brock Purdy at 26.7 years old is the oldest guy on his team. Only one other guy on his team is even 26 years old. See below for comparison to other teams in the league.

Who Drafted Young

Average age of each 2026 roster, weighted by auction price



Ages at Week 1, from Sleeper. Team defenses excluded. Weighting by price reflects where each owner's money actually went.

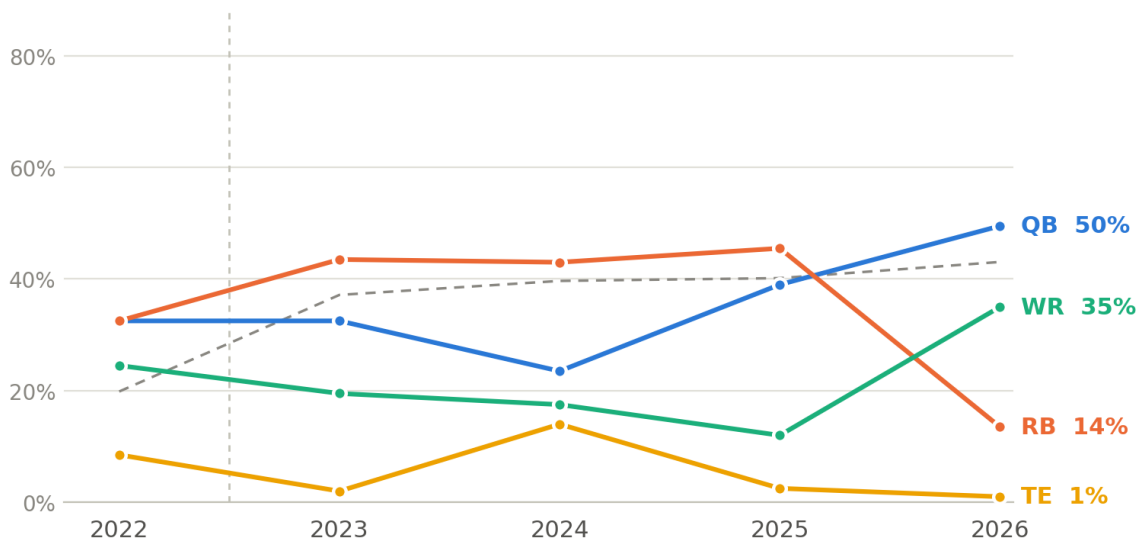
Travis Hunter in the flex? Like let's be reasonable. He's not even going to play offense this year. The committee even likes the upside for some of the rookies Pelosi is stashing on the bench like Zachariah "Deion" Branch and Kaytron Allen, but coming off an 0-14 season we have limited faith in this coaching staff's ability to get the best out of his players.

Pelosi did up his QB spend this year to be above league average for the first time. We'd like to award him credit for adapting to changing economic conditions.

Mikey

Share of own auction budget by position, 2022-2026

--- League avg QB



Best Value: Malik Nabers \$21. Assuming health, this guy has WR1 overall upside. For a measly \$21, that is a bet worth making even if health is hardly assured.

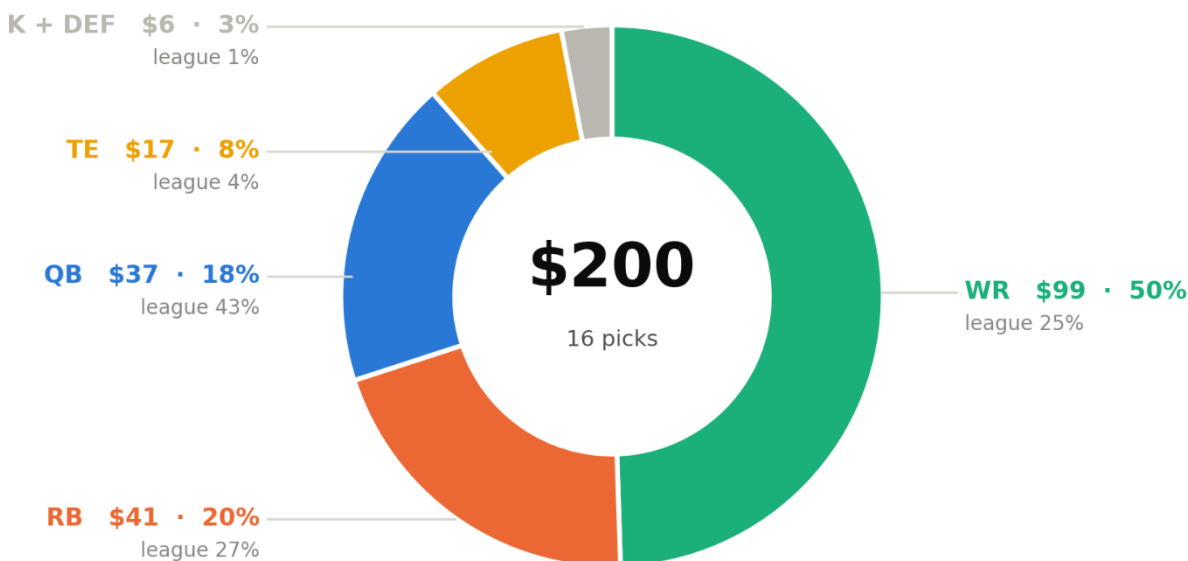
Biggest Reach: Jaxson Dart \$50. For a guy who hits the blue tent more often than Pelosi hits the bathroom for bumps, this is a bit pricey.

15. Tuanigamanuolepola Donny (Kevin)

As Shough and F#ck put in on the record, “I don’t know if he understood the rules of the draft.” Tua Donny came out of the draft with just the Cardinals QB room and backup QBs. This gives the committee little faith he can field a playoff caliber team even with a plethora of playmakers at the skill positions. He has 5 legitimately good receivers with London, Ladd, Rashee, Olave and McMillan. Couple that with Loveland at tight end and a solid running back group of Judkins, Bucky, Corum and Tua Donny has the assets to rectify his current positioning. Perhaps this will work out like it did for Free Paid last year when he rode monstrous running back play and one decent QB to a 13-1 record, but the committee views that strategy as more of an outlier. Perhaps Olave or McMillan will prove to be a more effective superflex than a bad QB, but we struggle to see the vision.

Kevin's First Draft

Where a rookie owner put his \$200, against how the league spent its money



Kickers and team defenses combined — \$6 between them. No prior seasons: 2026 is Kevin's first year in the league.

In four years of the league so far, there have been 8 league finalists. Only one of those teams was underweight on QB spend. And that was Sweeney last year when he spent \$79 vs league average of \$80. Every other finalist spent more than league average on QBs.

Best Value: Colston Loveland \$17. Loveland is going to be the top pass catcher in the Bears offense. We expect Travis Kelce 2022-type production.

Biggest Reach: Rashee Rice \$20. The head of a criminal syndicate known for stealing cars in and around the Kansas City area, it's only a matter of time before he's back inside of a cell.

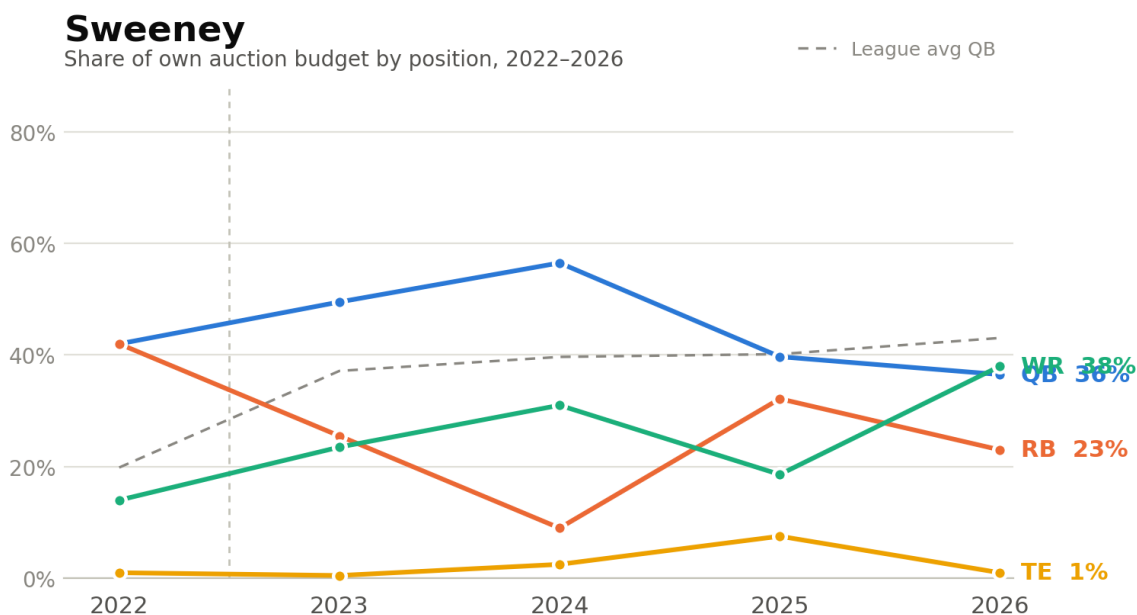
Editor's Note: Tua is already wheeling and dealing and a QB trade is very likely to happen before kickoff. We may need to have a 2nd version of preseason rankings closer to week one.

16. Work Ass (Sweeney)

In his own words "I have no chance of repeating". Harsh assessment but it is going to be an uphill battle for one of the more consistent franchises in the league. Work Ass has made three of the four league title games and won two titles, but his draft this year did not pan

out as he'd hoped. He spent more than \$2 on only 5 players which was the fewest in the league. And the 6th player he spent more than \$1 on was Brandon Aubrey. A heavy lean into stars and scrubs, but with an unreliable 2nd QB option of Fernando Mendoza. If Mendoza plays early, the committee is actually optimistic about this working out. However, Tom Brady and the wizards running the Raiders are convinced that he needs to sit for an extended period of time. Really makes you wonder what exactly Brady has been thinking for the past couple years, huh?

Still, we like a lot of the dart throws. Tre Harris, Terrance Ferguson and Kayshon Boutte could all be respectable flex options if things break right. And the stars he did draft are studs. McCaffrey and Chase are as close to locks as any skill guy can be. Dak is coming off a year when he was QB5 and he's got all his weapons coming back.



He likely went bargain bin shopping a little too heavy on QB and it might cost him.

Best Value: Christian McCaffrey \$44. When healthy, this guy is a top-3 running back every single year. And he went for only \$2 more than Jeremiyah Love.

Biggest Reach: Brandon Aubrey \$2. Not a lot of options here with how Work Ass spent his budget, but extra cash for a kicker is probably not ideal.

Relegated: Papi

